WRITTEN TESTIMONY OF THE ARDEN CLIMATE COALITION

Submitted to the Senate Committee on Energy and Environment, 26 March 2025

The Coalition supports the bill and urges its passage without weakening amendment.

Arden has been struck twice by hurricanes in five years and has suffered the worst flood in its recorded history. Whole neighbourhoods in the interior have not been rebuilt. The Coalition's volunteers have logged 9,454 hours in flood recovery since 2021.

The principle of the bill is that those who profit from the sale of the products whose combustion causes the harm should contribute to repairing it. That principle is not novel and the Coalition does not accept that it becomes novel because the sums are large.

The Coalition notes that the renewable sector in Arden now employs some 3,026 people and that its growth has not depended on charges levied on competitors. The Coalition does not support the bill on the ground that it will advantage any Arden industry and would oppose any amendment directing the fund to industry assistance.

On the property fee, the Coalition is divided. 50 per cent of members responding to the Coalition's survey supported it. The Coalition takes no position.

The Coalition asks the Committee to reject the argument that the State must wait for federal action. Federal action has been withdrawn, not extended.

The Coalition is a membership organisation of ninety-four local groups.